

what they are interested in outside the product or the service that needs to be marketed are critical demographics in themselves which help in the general understanding of how a particular network is put to use.

Finding out the platform on which the business competitors of that particular business have successfully engaged with their audience also provides a rough sketch as to which social network is most compatible for the business. Google keyword searches that include the business, as well as the social network name, is fruitful in identifying the social media platform that the concerned market is the strongest in.

Even if the business is one that caters to an audience-specific, niche market, it is absolutely surprising to discover that a broad spectrum of users exists over a multitude of social media, and they are interested in that niche market and might even be prospective customers who are hovering in that slot.

Defining objectives

It is profoundly important for a business proprietor to define the social media marketing goals at the point of inception of their online business. It is essential to understand what business owners want for themselves and their businesses: to expand the customer bases, spread word of mouth and market the businesses or engage with the base of customers the business currently possesses. Audits of the businesses are also crucial in identifying marketing plan gaps which are most probably causing the miscue.

Though the primary objective remains the same, that is, driving sales by attracting customers, the associated objectives and ways to achieve the primary one vary. In some cases, the businesses use social media to drive brand recognition, whereas in others they use social media to develop amicable relationships with the potential customers. In other cases yet, social media is often used for online customer support.

A few fitting questions should be borne in mind whose answers would provide the key in establishing the objectives for social media marketing. Is it important for the proprietor to grow their customer base, or they focus on building customer loyalty and improving service to those loyal customers? Whether improving services can be bolstered by creating a channel for customer feedback and the data can be utilized in the same or if the user base can be extended by updating them on the newest offers, products or services. The questions also involve ways to increase website traffic and modes of conducting informal market research.